

Experiment 6 – Qualys Virtual Scanner Appliance Deployment and Configuration

OBJECTIVE

To deploy and personalize a Qualys Virtual Scanner Appliance in a VirtualBox lab environment, establish the required network connectivity, verify cloud connectivity and prepare the scanner for authorized assessment of a Kali Linux target.

REQUIREMENTS

- Windows host system
- Oracle VirtualBox
- Active Qualys subscription
- Permission to manage Virtual Scanner Appliances
- Qualys Virtual Scanner Appliance OVA
- 14-digit scanner personalization code
- Kali Linux virtual machine
- Network connectivity
- CPU and RAM resources according to the laboratory requirement

DETAILED STEPS

1. Log in to the Qualys Cloud Platform using an account that is authorized to manage virtual scannerappliances.
2. Open the scanner/appliance management section and navigate to Scans > Appliances.
3. Select New > Virtual Scanner Appliance and start the setup wizard.
4. Provide a suitable friendly name for the scanner and continue through the wizard.
5. Obtain the personalization code supplied by Qualys for the appliance. Keep the actual code private and donot include it in the lab record.
6. Download the Qualys Virtual Scanner Appliance OVA provided by the platform.
7. Open Oracle VirtualBox on the Windows host and select Import Appliance.
8. Select the downloaded OVA and import it into VirtualBox.
9. Review the virtual-machine settings and allocate CPU and RAM according to the laboratory requirement.
10. Configure the network adapters according to the lab design. One interface may provide access toward theQualys Cloud Platform while another can provide the controlled lab network used with Kali, when required by the setup.
11. Start the virtual scanner appliance.
12. Open the appliance console and select the personalization/configuration option.
13. Enter the 14-digit personalization code and complete the personalization process.
14. Wait for the appliance to establish communication with the Qualys Cloud Platform.
15. Return to Qualys and open Scans > Appliances.

16. Locate the scanner by its friendly name and inspect its IP address and connection state.
17. Confirm that the appliance is shown as connected/online before attempting a scan.
18. Start the Kali Linux virtual machine and connect it to the intended controlled lab network.
19. Run ip addr in Kali Linux to identify the target IP address.
20. Confirm the network configuration is suitable for the authorized lab assessment.
21. If the practical requires a scan, create a controlled vulnerability scan in Qualys, select the Virtual ScannerAppliance and specify the Kali Linux lab IP as the authorized target.
22. Launch the scan and monitor its status from the Qualys console.
23. After completion, review the scan information and document the findings required by the practical.

CONCLUSION

The practical demonstrates the lifecycle of a Qualys Virtual Scanner Appliance: provisioning the appliance, importing it into the virtualization platform, personalizing it, establishing cloud connectivity, verifying its online state and preparing it for authorized internal vulnerability assessment.